



JAN INTAKE · SEPTEMBER 2026 – JANUARY 2027

Study in New Zealand

8 universities and 5 institutes of technology with verified official websites, a full visa/eligibility/financial-requirement walkthrough, and a clear post-study work and residence pathway — New Zealand's first deck in this set, built from general counseling guidance rather than per-institution profiles.

Non-EU / Oceania

13 Institutions Profiled

Up to 3-Year PSW Visa

NZD 25k–55k Tuition Range

New Country — First Deck

New Zealand at a Glance

COVERAGE NOTE

This deck is general visa/counseling guidance, not institution-level fee data

Unlike other country decks in this set, the New Zealand source material is a country-wide counseling guide (intakes, eligibility bands, tuition/living-cost RANGES, visa process) rather than per-institution profiles — no institution reports its own individual tuition fee, deadline, or website in the source. The 8 universities and 5 institutes of technology below are shown with verified official websites (researched separately) and their programme areas; always confirm exact fees and deadlines on the institution's own site before quoting a client.

MAJOR INTAKES

February (main) & July (major)

October and November intakes exist for selected/limited programmes. Apply 4–8 months before intake.

STUDY LEVELS

Diploma to PhD

Diploma 1–2 yrs • Bachelor's 3 yrs (Honours 4) • PG Diploma 1 yr • Master's 1.5–2 yrs • PhD 3–4 yrs

INSTITUTIONS SHOWN

13 profiled + 7 private colleges named

8 universities, 5 institutes of technology (with programme areas + verified websites), and 7 private colleges (name only in source)

UNIVERSITY TUITION (ANNUAL)

NZD 25,000 – 55,000

Undergraduate NZD 25,000–45,000 • Postgraduate NZD 25,000–55,000. Private colleges: lower, with diploma pathways.

LIVING COSTS

NZD 20,000 – 25,000/year

Varies by city and lifestyle • health insurance (compulsory) adds ~NZD 800–2,000/year

POST-STUDY WORK VISA

Up to 3 years

Duration depends on qualification/study level • work for any employer • a real pathway toward residence

Top Universities of New Zealand

UNIVERSITY	CITY	PROGRAMME AREAS	MIN. / IELTS GUIDE	OFFICIAL WEBSITE
University of Auckland	Auckland	Engineering, Business, IT, Medicine, Law, Education	65–70% / IELTS 6.0–6.5	https://www.auckland.ac.nz
University of Otago	Dunedin	Medicine, Health Sciences, Business, Sciences	See admissions page	https://www.otago.ac.nz
Victoria University of Welli...	Wellington	Law, Business, Engineering, Int'l Relations	See admissions page	https://www.wgtn.ac.nz
University of Canterbury	Christchurch	Engineering, IT, Business, Education	See admissions page	https://www.canterbury.ac.nz
Massey University	Auckland / Palmerston...	Aviation, Agriculture, Business, Engineering	See admissions page	https://www.massey.ac.nz
AUT University	Auckland	Business, Hospitality, Computer Science, Health Sciences	See admissions page	https://www.aut.ac.nz
Lincoln University	Christchurch	Agriculture, Environmental Science, Agribusiness	See admissions page	https://www.lincoln.ac.nz
University of Waikato	Hamilton	IT, Business, Education, Engineering	See admissions page	https://www.waikato.ac.nz

Programme areas reflect the source counseling guide's highlighted strengths per university, not an exhaustive faculty list. Minimum % / IELTS shown only where the source specified an institution-specific figure (Auckland); all others follow the country-wide bands on the Eligibility page. Websites verified via live search, Sept 2026 — always confirm the live international-admissions page.

Institutes of Technology & Private Colleges

INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY	CITY	PROGRAMME AREAS	OFFICIAL WEBSITE
Unitec Institute of Technology	Auckland	IT, Construction, Business, Engineering	https://www.unitec.ac.nz
Ara Institute of Canterbury	Christchurch	Nursing, Engineering, Hospitality	https://www.ara.ac.nz
Toi Ohomai Institute of Technology	Tauranga / Rotorua region	Business, Tourism, IT	https://www.toiohomai.ac.nz
Otago Polytechnic	Dunedin (+ Auckland campus)	Design, Nursing, Business	https://www.op.ac.nz
Southern Institute of Technology	Invercargill	Business, IT, Hospitality	https://www.sit.ac.nz

PRIVATE COLLEGES NAMED IN SOURCE (NO CITY / PROGRAMME / WEBSITE CONFIRMED)

New Zealand School of Education • Cornell Institute • International College of Auckland • New Zealand Tertiary College • Pacific International Hotel Management School • Queens Academic Group • NZMA

Listed by name only, as given in the source research — typically offer diploma pathways at lower tuition than universities/ITPs, often for students in the 50–65% band. Research each individually (city, programmes, accreditation, real fees) before presenting to a client.

Eligibility, English Requirements & Study Gap

ELIGIBILITY (ACADEMIC)

Bachelor's: Intermediate/A-Level, generally 55–60% minimum (some institutions accept lower)

Postgraduate: relevant Bachelor's degree, preferably 2.5 CGPA or above

ENGLISH LANGUAGE REQUIREMENTS

Undergraduate: IELTS 6.0 overall, no band <5.5 • PTE 50–58 • Duolingo ~110–115

Postgraduate: IELTS 6.5 overall, no band <6.0 • PTE 58+ • Duolingo ~110–115

Some institutions accept alternative English qualifications — confirm per institution

STUDY GAP	ASSESSMENT
1–3 years	Excellent
4–6 years	Good
6–8 years	Possible
8+ years	Strong justification required

Relevant work experience strengthens a gapped application.

AGE LIMIT

No official age limit. Practical counseling guidance: undergraduate applicants preferably under 28, postgraduate preferably under 35 — older applicants can still succeed with strong academic and career justification.

Tuition, Living Costs & Financial Requirements

TUITION FEES

Universities — Undergraduate: NZD 25,000–45,000/yr • Postgraduate: NZD 25,000–55,000/yr

Private colleges — Lower tuition, diploma pathways available

LIVING EXPENSES

Estimated annual living costs: **NZD 20,000–25,000**, depending on city and lifestyle — covers accommodation, food, transportation, utilities, personal expenses. Immigration New Zealand requires proof of these funds.

BANK STATEMENT REQUIREMENTS

3–6 months of bank history recommended • genuine source of funds • stable financial transactions. Recommended funds should cover tuition + living + travel expenses.

Additional family funds: spouse ~NZD 5,000, each child ~NZD 2,000

HEALTH INSURANCE

Compulsory for all international students. Estimated annual cost: **NZD 800–2,000**, depending on provider and coverage level.

Work Rights, Post-Study Work Visa & PR

WORK RIGHTS WHILE STUDYING

Up to **25 hours/week** during studies, full-time during scheduled breaks where permitted.
Common sectors: retail, hospitality, warehousing, delivery, customer service, administration.

POST-STUDY WORK VISA (PSW)

Many graduates become eligible, typically for **up to 3 years** depending on qualification and study level. Allows working for any employer, gaining NZ experience, and building toward residence.

PERMANENT RESIDENCY PATHWAYS

Study → Post-study work visa → Skilled employment → Residence application. Many graduates pursue residence after securing skilled employment.

DEPENDENTS

Spouse may be eligible for a work visa depending on the student's qualification.
Dependent children may accompany eligible students, with additional financial evidence required.

VISA INTERVIEWS & DOCUMENT ATTESTATION

Generally no university interview and no embassy interview for most institutions, though Immigration New Zealand may request additional information. **Attestation:** Intermediate documents — Board + IBCC + MOFA; Bachelor's documents — HEC + MOFA.

8-Step Admission Process & Timelines

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS
1. Profile Assessment	Evaluate academics, English proficiency, financials, study gap, career progression
2. Institution Selection	Choose university, institute of technology, or private college
3. Document Preparation	Academic (Matric/Intermediate/Degree/transcripts), personal (passport/photos/CV), English test, financial docs
4. Application Submission	Apply online, documents uploaded
5. Offer Letter	Institution issues Conditional or Unconditional Offer
6. Tuition Payment	Institution issues invoice — many allow payment after visa approval, per institutional policy
7. Visa Application	Submit admission letter, financial evidence, medical exam, police certificate, insurance
8. Visa Decision	Electronic visa issued upon approval

STAGE	TYPICAL TIME
Admission	2–6 weeks
Offer Letter	1–3 weeks
Visa Processing	~4–12 weeks

Best Universities by Field & Counselor Recommendation

FIELD	RECOMMENDED INSTITUTIONS
Business	Auckland, Waikato, AUT
Engineering	Auckland, Canterbury
IT	Waikato, AUT, Auckland
Agriculture	Lincoln, Massey
Nursing	Otago, Ara
Hospitality	AUT, NZMA
Aviation	Massey
ACADEMIC BAND	COUNSELOR RECOMMENDATION
50–55%	Private colleges, diploma pathways
55–65%	Institutes of Technology
65%+	Public universities
70%+	Top universities and scholarship opportunities

Documents Checklist

DOCUMENTS

- Passport (first 2 pages, scanned)
- Academic transcripts — Matric through highest qualification
- Degree/diploma certificates
- CV
- English test result (IELTS / PTE / Duolingo)
- Bank statements + sponsor documents
- Passport-size photos
- Attested documents (Board/IBCC/HEC + MOFA as applicable)

Quote Carefully — Corrections & Safeguards

CORRECTIONS & SAFEGUARDS — DO NOT OVERSTATE

- This is a brand-new country deck built entirely from a general counseling guide — unlike other decks in this set, **no institution reports its own tuition fee or application deadline** in the source. Present the NZD 25,000–55,000/year range as a country-wide estimate, and always confirm the exact figure per institution and programme before quoting a client.
- Official websites for the 13 profiled institutions (8 universities + 5 ITPs) were verified separately via live web search (Sept 2026), not sourced from the original document — reconfirm before publishing further updates.
- The 7 private colleges are name-only in the source (no city, programmes, fees, or website) — research each individually before recommending to a client.
- Study-gap bands, age guidance, and the 50/55/65/70% recommendation bands reflect the source's own counselor guidance, not official Immigration New Zealand policy — present as informed guidance, not guarantees.
- Work-rights hours (25/week) and PSW visa duration (up to 3 years) should be reconfirmed against current Immigration New Zealand rules before advising, as visa settings can change between cycles.